

BASICS: ROLE ASSIGNMENT, SIMPLE TASK, REFINEMENT

Scenario

Alexa Rivera is Director of Engineering at a mid-sized SaaS company. Her first goal is to prepare for your weekly team meeting.

Prompt (AI Role Assignment)

You are a leadership coach with over 20 years of experience coaching senior leaders in fast-moving technology roles. You are helping me become a more effective leader using Generative AI as a tool. Unless otherwise specified keep your answers concise and impactful.

My name is Alexa Rivera, I am the Director of Engineering at TechFlow solutions, a mid-sized SaaS company. I have 4 Engineering Managers as direct reports. My focus is on aligning technical strategy with business goals, delivering key product features, and growing the team and I report to the VP of Engineering. I will initiate a series of requests and I'd like you to help me. This conversation should be closed. Do you understand our roles?

Prompt (Task Request)

Help me prepare for my weekly team meeting. I need to provide a 3-minute verbal update on team performance, key wins from last week, and focus areas for the week ahead. Here is the data to include.

Key Wins: We increased support ticket resolution by 20% and hit 75% completion on the onboarding tool beta.

This Week's Focus: Progressing work on the backend for the onboarding tool and preparing for user testing.

Follow-up prompt

Give me two versions. One that is more formal for my VP and one that is conversational and inspiring for my team that uses simple, clear language that emphasizes teamwork and growth.

GOAL SETTING FOR THE NEXT MONTH

Scenario

At the end of the team meeting, Alexa realized she needs to set clear, achievable goals for the month for the work on the onboarding tool and user testing.

Prompt

Last week, I ran a team meeting where I provided a company update. Now I need to set 3 clear, measurable goals for the month for my team. Our focus is on progressing the backend for the onboarding tool and preparing for user testing. Help me create 3 SMART goals related to these themes.

Follow-up Prompt

Can you add success metrics or milestones we can track weekly?

MANAGING CONFLICTING PRIORITIES

Scenario

A week later, external priorities shift. The CFO announces a new company-wide cost-cutting initiative that requires immediate action. This new priority conflicts with Alexa's current focus on the onboarding tool and user testing.

Alexa needs some help rebalancing priorities and communicating with her team.

Prompt

Since setting my goals last week, the CFO announced a company-wide cost-cutting initiative that I must prioritize. This conflicts with my team's goals of finalizing the onboarding tool and preparing for user testing. Using the Eisenhower Matrix tell me how should I adjust my priorities, and what should I communicate to my team to keep them aligned and focused?

Follow-Up Prompt

Anticipate 3 possible concerns my team might have after hearing about the new cost-cutting initiative. For each concern, provide a suggestion for how I can address it proactively.

DELEGATING TASKS EFFECTIVELY

Scenario

As part of the cost cutting initiatives, Alexa has been asked to research 3 ways to reduce operating expenses in her department.

After reassessing her workload, Alexa realizes she can't manage all her priorities alone. She needs to decide what to delegate, to whom on her team, and how to communicate that.

Prompt

I've been asked to research 3 ways to reduce operating expenses in my department as part of a company-wide cost-cutting initiative. I want to evaluate if I should own it myself or delegate it to one of my team members.

Here's what I'm currently managing:

Finalizing the backend onboarding tool: I'm overseeing progress and supporting the team to ensure we hit our deadline.

User testing: I'm responsible for coordinating testing feedback with managers and ensuring any critical issues are resolved on time.

Team development: I have ongoing coaching conversations with two of my Engineering Managers this month as part of their development plans.

VP reporting: I have a standing weekly report due to the VP of Product every Friday.

Given this workload, should I own this new cost-cutting research task myself or delegate it to one of my Engineering Managers? If I should delegate it, what criteria should I use to select the right person for the task?

Follow-up Prompt

I want to delegate the research task. I have 4 Engineering Managers on my team — Raj, Sarah, Taylor, and Mia.

Here's a brief summary of each person:

Raj: Highly experienced technical leader, great at troubleshooting complex issues, and known for his efficiency in problem-solving. Currently leading a high-priority project with tight deadlines.

Sarah: Detail-oriented and strong at analysis. She has experience with process optimization and has a natural eye for finding cost-saving opportunities. Her current workload is manageable.

Taylor: Excellent communicator and team motivator. Has a strong understanding of how cross-functional teams work together. This month, she is focused on onboarding new hires.

Mia: Skilled in cross-functional collaboration and process improvement. She's leading the QA effort for an upcoming release and has experience running small internal process reviews in the past.

Based on their skills, availability, and capacity, who should I delegate this task to? Please provide a clear recommendation with reasoning for your choice.

Follow-Up Prompt

Write an email to Sarah explaining the task clearly, defining deliverables, and setting a deadline of next Friday.

COACHING A TEAM MEMBER

Scenario

Sarah responded to the delegation email saying she feels overwhelmed with her workload.

Alexa wants to provide some coaching for Sarah on how to manage her workload effectively but needs a plan to do so.

Prompt

Sarah responded to the delegation email saying she feels overwhelmed with her workload. See below. I want to have a 1-on-1 coaching conversation with her to help her prioritize tasks better. Create a step-by-step agenda for our coaching conversation.

Hi Alexa,

I'm really trying to keep everything on track, but I have to be honest — I'm feeling pretty overwhelmed right now. With everything already on my plate — the QA work for the onboarding tool, the process improvement tasks, and all the smaller ad-hoc requests that keep popping up — I'm not sure how I'm supposed to fit this research in.

I don't want to drop the ball on anything, but it's starting to feel like I might. I'm worried I won't be able to give this project the time or attention it needs, and I don't want to let you down. I know this is important, but I'm struggling to see where I can carve out space for it.

Can we figure out a way to make this more manageable? I'm open to ideas, but right now, it feels like too much is hitting at once.

Thanks,
Sarah

Follow-Up Prompt

Can you suggest 3 powerful coaching questions I can ask Sarah to help her reflect on her workload and identify her top priorities?

DELIVERING CONSTRUCTIVE FEEDBACK

Scenario

Sarah delivered her cost-cutting report 2 days late and did not notify Alexa. The content was fine, but the delay created extra stress for you as Alexa had to scramble to answer questions from the VP.

Alexa wants to give her constructive feedback to ensure she communicates better in the future.

Prompt

I need to have a constructive feedback conversation with Sarah. She recently delivered her cost-cutting report 2 days late and didn't notify me of the delay. While the content was solid, the delay created extra stress for me as I had to respond to questions from the VP. I want to be clear but supportive. Write a step-by-step script using the SBI model that I can follow for this conversation.

Follow-Up Prompt

How can I frame my feedback so Sarah understands the impact of her delay without making her feel blamed or defensive?

HOLDING TEAM MEMBERS ACCOUNTABLE

Scenario

After the constructive feedback conversation about her late cost-cutting report, Sarah agreed to provide updates to Alexa proactively. However, in the following weeks, she missed two more key deadlines, and the pattern is starting to impact team deliverables.

Alexa wants to create an accountability plan with Sarah that clearly defines expectations, deadlines, and regular check-ins to track progress.

Prompt

I need to have an accountability conversation with Sarah. Despite our previous conversations about proactive communication, she's missed two more deadlines without notifying me. This is starting to affect team deliverables. I want to be clear but fair. Help me design an accountability plan with Sarah that includes clear expectations, deadlines, and weekly check-ins. I'd like a step-by-step script I can follow for this conversation.

Follow-Up Prompt

Turn this framework into a 1-page document I can share with Sarah so we both stay aligned.

BUILDING AN ACTION PLAN

Scenario

Now that you've set goals, delegated tasks, and created an accountability plan, Alexa needs to consolidate all this into an action plan for the next 30 days.

Prompt

Given everything we've talked about, help me create a 30-day leadership action plan. Include my 3 key monthly goals, how I will manage changing priorities, and how I will support my team through coaching, delegation, and accountability. Provide clear weekly milestones for each goal.